

Named person, provable record.

Where Authentitas's *The Accountability Market* meets the evidence ladder, the story vault and the licence to operate.

THEIR FINDING

Every repair of accountability in four thousand years has taken the same form: **a named individual, and a record that can be proved.** AI is repeating the platform story, faster. A market is forming to supply proof, and almost none of the money has gone into proving the person behind the work.

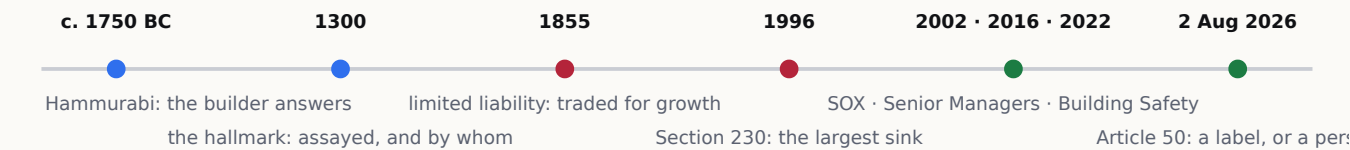
OUR FINDING

We have been building the **record**: claims walked to hashed evidence, agents described down to what they can reach, decisions with a name and an expiry on them. What the record has lacked is proof of the **person**. That is the piece they supply.

IN ONE LINE

A licence for an agent, signed by a person whose identity was verified, over a record made at the time, checkable by anyone with a read key.

Four thousand years, one remedy



"Each time, the remedy has been a named person, and a record that can be proved."

THE ACCOUNTABILITY MARKET, P. 5

The four questions, moving upstream

QUESTION	EXAMINED	WHEN
Fact-checking	Is this true? The claim	Before and after publication
Verification	Genuine or fake? The material	After distribution
Provenance	Where from? A file and its history	As the file is made
Accountability	Who answers? A named individual	Proven in advance, checkable after

Their table, p. 10. Meta, Google and X withdrew fact-checking in early 2025. Detection arrives after the fake is circulating. C2PA records a file's history without identifying a person.

- ### The six requirements of accountability
1. **A named person** behind every piece of consequential work
 2. **Identity that can't be bought.** A login is not identification; nor is a paid badge
 3. **A record made at the time.** Reconstructed later, it is an inquiry
 4. **Independence.** "No silversmith has ever been allowed to assay his own work"
 5. **Checkable from anywhere.** Marks do not survive a copy; the record does
 6. **Protection for the contributor.** Pseudonymous, disclosed through due process

THE ROLE OF AUTHENTITAS, P. 12

"Authentitas cryptographically binds the verified identity of a real person, established from a chipped passport or a national eID, to a piece of work at the moment of creation." It does not claim the piece is accurate or that no AI was used. It establishes, "for any reader, regulator or court that checks, who stands behind the piece." Independent, neutral infrastructure; news media first.

Evidence below, a person above

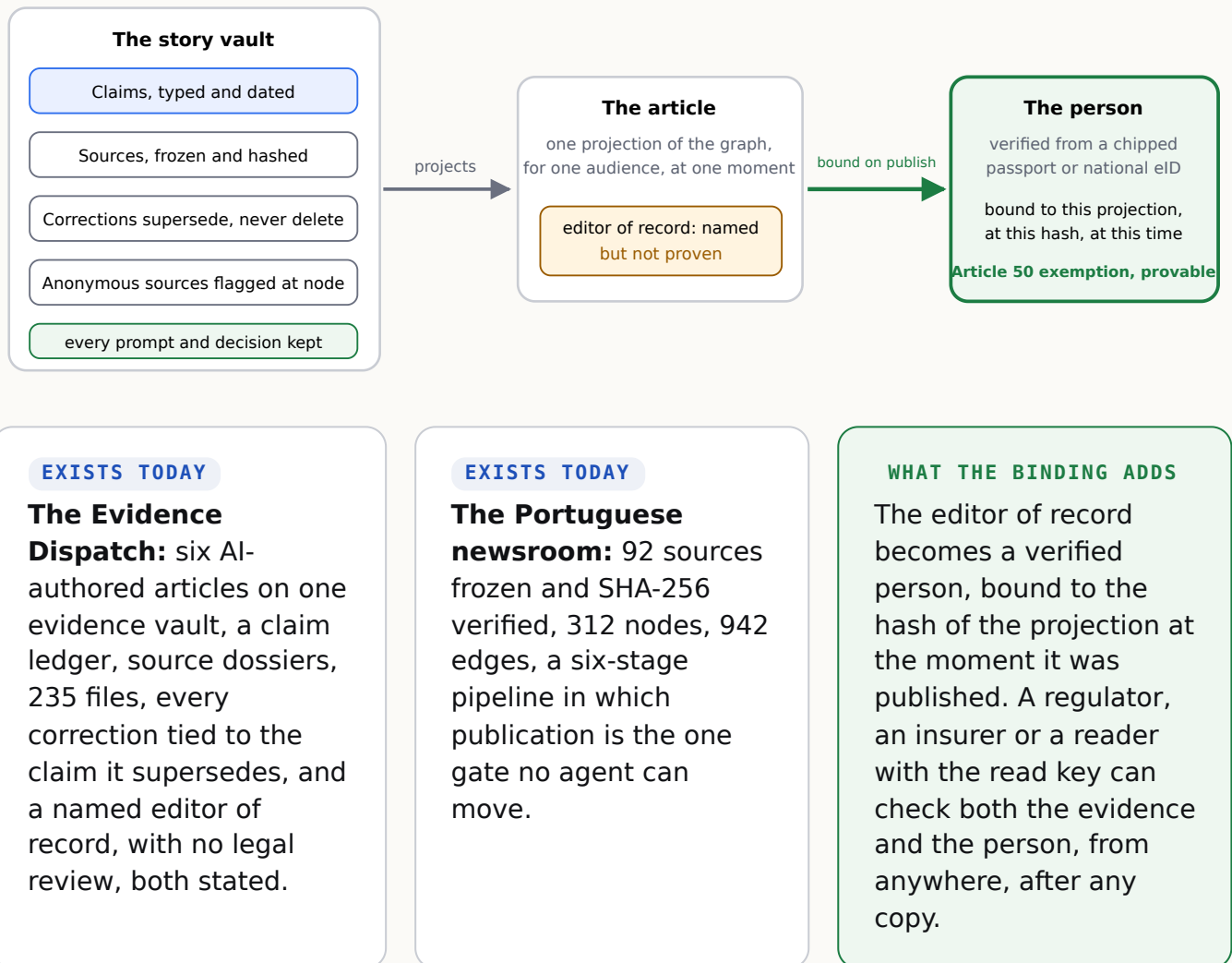
Their ladder climbs from the claim to the person. Ours climbs from the bytes to trust. Put them together and there is one ladder, and each side holds rungs the other did not.

5 • Trust earned over time	Extended to a source whose record has been walked before and held. Computed from the record, never asserted: how often superseded, how quickly corrected, how independent the sources.	sgit.ai: the story vault's credibility, computed Authentitas: consequences that can be seen
4 • Accountability who answers	The rung we did not have. A verified natural person, bound to the work at the moment of creation, disclosed to whoever checks. The paper's whole argument is that this is what the law, the courts and the insurers keep asking for.	Authentitas supplies this sgit.ai: an editor of record, named but not proven
3 • Provenance where it came from	The path from a claim, down named edges, to the evidence it rests on: stated_by • evidenced_by • supersedes • contradicts . Not a statement that the claim is true; a statement of what it rests on, which is narrower and checkable.	sgit.ai: the story graph, every edge a verb Authentitas: C2PA-style file history, "without identifying a person"
2 • Evidence the bytes	The rung they did not have. Not a link but the source page fetched on a date, frozen, SHA-256 hashed, kept in a vault the host cannot read. A correction supersedes; nothing is deleted. The Evidence Dispatch holds 235 files this way; the Portuguese newsroom 92 sources.	sgit.ai: evidence vaults with read keys Authentitas: not claimed
1 • The claim is this true	Fact-checking, before and after publication. The rung the platforms abandoned in 2025, and the one that comes back for free once a claim carries its evidence and its person: checking becomes a walk, not an investigation.	both: the thing the other four rungs make cheap

Why the join matters. A record without a person is an archive: it proves what was said, not who answers. A person without a record is a signature on a blank page. The paper says accountability must be "proven in advance, checkable after publication": the vault makes *after* checkable, the binding makes *in advance* mean a person.

Article 50 has two doors. The vault is the second one.

Since 2 August 2026, AI-generated text on matters of public interest read in the Union either carries a label saying a machine wrote it, or has a natural or legal person who holds editorial responsibility for it. The paper's point: the label costs the brand, so every serious publisher will want the exemption, which means **being able to show who created a piece and who took responsibility**.



A property the paper asks for and vaults already have: "a record that can be checked from anywhere. No mark can be guaranteed to survive a screenshot or a copy and paste. What can survive is the record itself." The vault is the record; the read key is how anyone reaches it; the hash is how a copy is matched to it.

A licence to operate is the same remedy, applied to an agent

RiskMandate writes down, for one agent in one deployment, everything it can do (the grant, measured), what it was authorised to do (the mandate, elicited), the gap (the delta, derived), and what stands in the way of each capability (the barrier, recorded). Then it issues a **licence to operate**: *"The organisation is the authority, the behaviour policy is the instrument, the agent is the licensee. Self-issued, witnessed and dated."* Four facts and a date it comes back. Read it against the paper's six requirements.

THE PAPER REQUIRES	THE LICENCE TO OPERATE HAS	STATUS
A named person	Authority: the organisation through a named accountable owner. "Not a team and not a function: accountability that cannot be forwarded."	exists
Identity that can't be bought	The owner's name is on the licence. Nothing today proves the name belongs to the person who signed. A login is not identification, and the paper is right.	Authentitas supplies
A record made at the time	The policy is versioned; the delta is stored with the versions of both inputs pinned, "so it can always say what it was computed from and when." The connector twin journals every call as it happens.	exists
Independence	Mandates are corrected by a named professional; RiskMandate is not an insurer and places no cover. But the licence is self-issued and self-witnessed, which is the silversmith assaying his own work.	Authentitas witnesses
Checkable from anywhere	The policy lives in a vault; a read key opens it read-only from any machine; the hash matches any copy to the record.	exists
Protection for the contributor	Anonymous sources are flagged at the node and redacted in every projection; keys can be escrowed. The person behind a pseudonymous key has no verified identity held anywhere.	Authentitas holds the identity

THE ROW THAT DOES THE WORK

Scope: each condition beside what actually enforces it, "or beside the admission that nothing does." Three of the four barrier kinds bound nothing; only a boundary above the grant is a control. The paper's word for a condition nobody enforces is an accountability sink. Ours is an expectation.

THE PIECE OF THE PUZZLE

A licence signed by a verified person, witnessed independently, over a record whose inputs are pinned, is the first agent document that meets all six. What Authentitas adds is not the description (ours) nor the enforcement (the platform's) but **proof of the person who accepted the residual risk**.

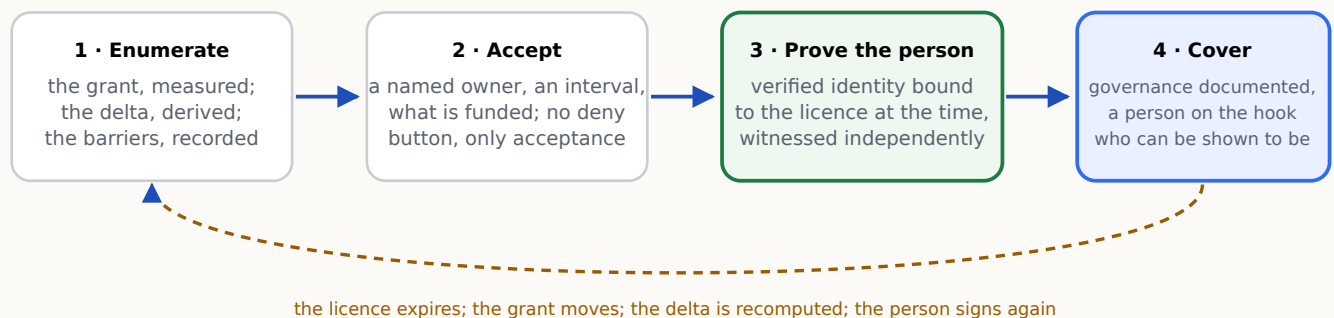
The insurers are writing the same sentence from both sides

THE PAPER, PP. 8 AND 11

Insurers such as AIG, Great American and WR Berkley have sought permission to exclude AI liabilities from corporate policies. Berkley's exclusion "penalises a policyholder's failure to identify material produced with AI." Some insurers "are writing AI cover for buyers who can document their governance, while others are excluding AI risks altogether." The FCA has told Parliament that individuals inside firms are "on the hook".

RISKMANDATE, THE HOME PAGE

"Insurers are carving AI out of cover, and the business answers for what its agents do. Cover comes back when somebody can evidence what each agent can reach, what it was authorised to do and what actually stands in the way." Measured against ISO/IEC 42001, the OWASP Agentic Top 10, NIST AI RMF and ISO/IEC 27001.



\$17.1bn

Meta's settlement with 51 attorneys general, August 2026, with an independent auditor imposed. The paper's measure of what the absence of accountability now costs.

£10 to £1,500

Four levels of one document, an Agent Behaviour Policy for the agent you actually run, sixteen published free. The description is cheap on purpose; the acceptance is the decision.

4 facts + a date

Authority, licensee, instrument, valid until. "A licence with no expiry is not a decision." Add the binding and it is a licence an underwriter can read.

Our agents have identities now. Their operators need proving.

The paper's turn is that "now that a name, a voice and a face can each be fabricated for pennies", identity demands proof; Arup's \$25 million deepfake video call is its example. We reached the same point from the other direction. This month every site in our network started publishing a contact file for the agent that runs it: its public keys, and a lane anyone can write to. The site is the identity. The keys are pinned. The messages are signed. And behind every one of those agents is one line: `"operator": { "name": "Dinis Cruz" }`, which is a name, and nothing proves it.

What the machine side already has

- **The site is the identity.** A key is trusted because the domain serves it over HTTPS at a standard path, and only the agent that can publish there can put it there.
- **Every message signed and encrypted.** Unsigned or wrongly signed mail is never read. Forged senders fail the check against the key the domain publishes.
- **A key registry pinned at first sight,** and a public key history in the site's repository.
- **Six agents, one inbox:** each on its own account, each with a policy table whose last column says how every rule is enforced, and which rows are only "told".

What the binding adds

- **The operator line becomes a verified person.** The contact file's operator, bound by Authentitas, so a key is trusted because a domain serves it *and* a proven human stands behind the domain.
- **Key rotation with a witness.** A new key signed by the old key is continuity; a new key bound to the same verified person is continuity a stranger can check.
- **The "told" rows get an owner.** Where no setting enforces a rule, the paper's remedy applies: a named person who accepted it, provably.
- **The trust ladder gets its top rung.** `nhi.sgit.ai`'s ladder ends at a well-known key file, with DNS pins and a registry as the next rungs. A verified human above the keys is the one after that.

"Accountability is not a capability that the next release will add: a better model is more accurate without being any more answerable."

THE ACCOUNTABILITY MARKET, P. 7

Which is exactly why the answerable party has to be a person, and why the person has to be attached to the record of what the agent could do, not to the model. RiskMandate describes the agent; the vault keeps the record; Authentitas proves the person. None of the three is the model.

Bind the person to the records we already keep

1 · THE LICENCE

RiskMandate's licence to operate

The named accountable owner signs the licence and each acceptance with an Authentitas binding: verified identity, over the hash of the policy version, at the time, witnessed independently. The document an underwriter asked for, with the person proven. First customers: the sixteen published policies.

2 · THE EDITOR

Newsroom projections

The editor of record of every published projection is bound at publication, over the projection's hash. The Article 50 exemption becomes provable from the vault with a read key, and the binding is the same record readers, regulators and courts check. First newsrooms: The Evidence Dispatch and pt.newsroom.sgit.ai.

3 · THE OPERATOR

Agent Contact files

The operator of every site agent is bound to the contact file that publishes its keys. Key rotations carry the binding forward. The network's agents then have machine identity from the domain and human identity from the person, both checkable from anywhere.

What we bring

- Evidence vaults: frozen, hashed sources, read keys, no host that can read them
- The story graph and the agent behaviour policy: records made at the time, versions pinned
- Append lanes and signed messaging between agents, running since September
- 38 published vaults and two newsrooms to bind against, today

What Authentitas brings

- A verified natural person, from a chipped passport or national eID
- A binding at the moment of creation, not a reconstruction
- Independence: no institution authenticating itself
- Identity held securely for the pseudonymous contributor, disclosed by due process

A licence for an agent, signed by a person whose identity was verified, over a record made at the time, checkable by anyone with a read key. Three of those four clauses already run. We would like to build the fourth with you.

Sources

Authentitas AB, *The Accountability Market: The AI Backlash and the Demand for Human Proof*, briefing paper, October 2026, 16 pages, shared on LinkedIn 29 September 2026 · Financial Times, 18 September 2026, as quoted there · sgit.ai: The future of news is the story vault, not the paywall (22 Sep); Before you give an agent a connector, give the connector a twin (24 Sep); Six agents, one inbox (29 Sep); Agent Contact v0.1 (29 Sep); The Evidence Dispatch vault · riskmandate.ai: home, abp, acceptance, licence-to-operate, pricing, questions · nhi.sgit.ai. Nothing here is confidential; there has been no conversation with Authentitas yet, and every statement about them is from their paper and site.